made soon, he said, Israel's intractability would cause the initiative "to simply die on the vine." I agreed. But I also told him that by no means was the guilt all Israel's, and he agreed with me: "He believes [Israel] and the Syrians," I wrote in the diary, "may be playing a game . . . even though they are hostile toward each other, [they may favor] cutting up Lebanon between them."

Many Jews in America as well as in Israel had been shocked by Sharon's bombardment of Beirut, which was shown so graphically on the world's television screens, as well as by allegations over his failure to halt the massacre by Christian militiamen of hundreds of Palestinians at the Sabra and Shatila refugee camps. They saw the Israeli assault as diametrically opposed to the moral values of their culture, and told me they believed that Begin's and Sharon's policies were contrary to the principles upon which Israel was founded. Many let me know that they supported our peace initiative and wished us well, and a few began speaking out publicly in criticism of Begin and Sharon. I'm sure this was difficult and painful for them because of their devotion to Israel—but they spoke out anyway, because they were anxious to bring a lasting and secure peace to the land they loved. With their help, and by emphasizing to Begin and Sharon that their policies were jeopardizing America's support of Israel, I still hoped to persuade Israel to leave Lebanon. But throughout that long winter and early spring, I continued to get nowhere with Begin. I suspect his resolve was stiffened by his confidence that supporters of Israel in Congress would ensure that the United States would never reduce its support of Israel, as well as by my own oft-stated commitment to always stand by Israel.

In February 1983, after a judicial panel asserted that he had been indirectly responsible for the massacres at the Palestinian refugee camps, Ariel Sharon resigned as Israel's minister of defense and was succeeded by Moshe Arens, the